

Selected Board Meeting Transcript Excerpts

APRIL 14, 2025 | NEEDS ASSESSMENT & DISTRICTWIDE NIET/TAP

SOURCE INFORMATION

MEETING	South San Antonio ISD Board of Managers — Regular Meeting
MEETING DATE	April 14, 2025
AGENDA ITEM	NIET/TAP System Implementation; earlier TEA conservator remarks
MEETING VIDEO	April 14, 2025 Board Meeting Video
AGENDA DOCUMENT	April 14, 2025 NIET/TAP Board Packet
OFFICIAL MINUTES	April 14, 2025 Board Meeting Minutes

ABOUT THESE EXCERPTS

These are selected passages from the April 14, 2025 meeting relating to the Needs Assessment and approval of districtwide NIET/TAP. Quotations and timestamps were checked against the original meeting video. Minor verbal fillers, false starts, repeated words, punctuation, and paragraph breaks have been edited for readability without changing the speaker’s meaning. [...] indicates omitted material.

EXCERPT GUIDE

- 01 [Saavedra: Needs Assessment and exit criteria](#) · 00:33:09–00:33:54 · PDF page 2
- 02 [Hinojosa: NIET/TAP presentation](#) · 01:10:21–01:12:21 · PDF page 3
- 03 [Murguia: materials reviewed and proposed support](#) · 01:12:01–01:12:48 · PDF page 4

SELECTED EXCERPT 01

Saavedra: a new Needs Assessment

VIDEO TIME	00:33:09–00:33:54
MEETING VIDEO	Open video at 00:33:09 Use the timestamp above in the April 14 recording. Direct timestamp link not yet verified.

TRANSCRIPT

ABE SAAVEDRA | TEA CONSERVATOR

“I want to let you know that over the next several weeks, I will be conducting a needs assessment in the district, working with Dr. Hinojosa and his staff. The end result of that needs assessment, that will be presented to the Board when it’s completed, will be the identification of what TEA calls extra criteria goals, specific goals that, based on the needs assessment, will be identified that the Board, the district, Dr. Hinojosa will be working toward that. Every month as I complete my progress report, we basically go through those and identify how much progress has been made toward those exit extra criteria goals.”

EDITORIAL NOTES

- Saavedra ties this Needs Assessment to establishing TEA “exit criteria” goals. He does not describe it here as an assessment to determine whether NIET/TAP should be adopted; NIET/TAP appears later in the meeting as a separate agenda item.
- **His statement that he “will be conducting” the assessment “over the next several weeks” indicates that the new Needs Assessment had not yet been completed and suggests that the formal process was only beginning.** The decision to approve districtwide NIET/TAP was therefore made before the Needs Assessment was completed or presented to the Board.

TRANSCRIPT NOTE

Minor verbal fillers, false starts, and repeated words have been omitted for readability. Wording and meaning are otherwise preserved.

SELECTED EXCERPT 02

Hinojosa: presentation of NIET/TAP

VIDEO TIME	01:10:21–01:12:21
MEETING VIDEO	Open video at 01:10:21

TRANSCRIPT

SAUL HINOJOSA | SUPERINTENDENT

“So, NIET and TAP is an organization that I know I worked with in my previous district, and they were really instrumental in helping not only build capacity with their staff, but establish a system that rewards staff based on their performance. They have, in their system, they would come in, they would help us establish protocols for PLCs, establish protocols of how to evaluate teachers, establish protocols of how to evaluate master teachers. So it’s a system that really helps in establishing systems and processes and once they are in place then own staff are able to learn those processes where they’re here for about a year or two until we get good grasp, get the training necessary in order to implement these processes. So, again, the main goal is to build capacity with our teachers, our principals, and our staff. It will also allow our master teachers to become evaluators and then also establish a protocol for a pay-for-performance system in our district. So the principals would be eligible, our master teachers would be eligible, and our teachers would be eligible to receive this type of incentive pay in all of our campuses. Does anybody have any questions? And I just want to add the great thing is City Education Partners, after presenting to them, have agreed to fund pretty much about 80% of what it’s going to cost us.”

EDITORIAL NOTES

- **What does “build capacity” mean here?** Hinojosa repeatedly describes NIET/TAP as a way to “build capacity,” but he does not define what capacity South San teachers were lacking. His examples focus heavily on establishing systems and processes, rather than identifying specific gaps in teachers’ content knowledge, instructional skills, or ability to respond to student needs.
- **Why was a new districtwide system needed?** Many of the functions Hinojosa describes already existed in some form through PLCs, professional development and instructional coaching, T-TESS teacher evaluation, and the district’s Teacher Incentive Allotment system. His remarks do not identify what was deficient in those existing systems, what specific teacher capacity needed to be built, or why NIET/TAP was needed districtwide.

TRANSCRIPT NOTE

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SELECTED EXCERPT 03

Murguia: materials reviewed and proposed support

VIDEO TIME	01:12:01–01:12:48
MEETING VIDEO	Open video at 01:12:01

TRANSCRIPT

KELLY MURGUIA | BOARD MANAGER

“No question, but just a comment of reviewing the materials. It just seems like a really beneficial program. And one thing that I just like to point out is like the individualized support. So it’s not like a blanket system for our schools, and it recognizes the unique needs of each campus and strength-based coaching. So I think it’s going to be a really formative program, but I’m excited to learn more about it.”

EDITORIAL NOTES

- **What does “not like a blanket system” mean?** Murguia points to individualized support and the unique needs of each campus as reasons NIET/TAP would not operate as a blanket system. But individualized support can still occur inside a standardized system. Teachers may receive different coaching based on their needs while still working within the same overall structure for training, observation, evaluation, and instructional expectations.
- **Is the coaching actually strength-based?** Murguia describes the proposed coaching as “strength-based,” meaning support that would build on educators’ existing strengths. That is important because it reflects how the system was presented to the Board before implementation. But teachers’ descriptions of the system in practice have focused much more on identifying deficiencies, correcting practice, meeting rubric expectations, and demonstrating prescribed instructional behaviors than on building from their existing strengths. This raises a separate question about whether the coaching teachers experience matches the way it was described before the vote.

TRANSCRIPT NOTE

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